THE SHOW INVITES THE VIEWER TO **ASK HOW A NEWLY DECOLONISED NATION DRAWS ITSELF** ONTO SOMETHING THAT CREASES, BUCKLES, TEARS...

The show brings together a rare constellation of artists whose works are not often seen together. "The architectural and anatomical rigour of Progressive Artists' Group founder Sadanand K. Bakre and the uncompromising ink of F.N. Souza anchors one end of the spectrum, where cities, bodies and faith are drawn as if under pressure. Nearby, Somnath Hore, Jogen Chowdhury and Badri Narayan attend to the body as a site of wound, vulnerability and quiet resilience, lines that cut, cross-hatch and, at times, soothe," shares Sreejith. The exhibition also showcases works by artists such as Bireswar Sen, G.R. Santosh, J. Swaminathan, Ram Kumar, Bhupen Khakhar and Meera Mukherjee, among others. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

The exhibition is on till May 30

Ode to the Maestro

ART ▼

AN EXHIBITION AT GALLERY G IN BENGALURU CELEBRATES RAJA RAVI VARMA'S 178TH BIRTH ANNIVERSARY

What India Learned to See: From Battala to the Ravi Varma Press and Beyond is an exhibition about how India's visual imagination was shaped through print and how art became part of everyday life. Beginning with early bazaar woodcuts from Calcutta's Battala and moving through the landmark moment of the Ravi Varma Press, it traces how sacred imagery became widely accessible.



THE VETERAN'S TOUCH 'Kali' by Raja Ravi Varma

The exhibition is particularly apt for Raja Ravi Varma's birth anniversary because his press marked a decisive shift. "His chromolithographs didn't just reproduce images; they standardised how generations came to recognise Lakshmi, Saraswati, Krishna and other deities. What the show examines is how printmaking created a shared visual language. Through repetition and circulation, prints taught the eye what to see and how to recognise the divine, establishing a modern iconography that persists today," says Gitanjali Maini, managing trustee & CEO, Raja Ravi Varma Heritage Foundation.

As the exhibition demonstrates, what remained constant were key attributes of the gods, but everything else—the body, mood and setting—evolved across regions and presses. The exhibition brings together a significant corpus of works—oleographs, lithographs, chromolithographs, calendar prints and printed ephemera—highlighting not just finished images, but the wider ecosystem of visual culture, including postcards, labels and bazaar prints. ■

—Bindu Gopal Rao

The exhibition is on till May 31

OF GREATNESS



how the artworks—65 at DAG, Mumbai, and 35 at Chatterjee & Lal—can be viewed via three themes: "The nature and impact of the art scene inherited by artists of the post-Independence period; the increasing interest in social and political themes; and the transformation within the fine arts community to embrace an expanded definition of its remit, inspired by design and craft traditions."

The exhibition is a feast for the senses, with the names of formidable artists giving you an idea of its significance... N.S. Bendre, S.H. Raza, F.N. Souza, M.F. Husain, B. Prabha, V.S. Gaitonde, K.C.S. Paniker, Satish Gujral and so many others hold your interest with their statements that go far deeper than artistic expression. We feel the impact of looking beyond boundaries, which is clear in many of the artworks, be it Nandalal Bose's Japanese woodblock print titled 'Kaikeyi and Manthara' or Jamini Roy's 'Untitled' (Madonna and Jesus with the Magi) tempera on board. *Epochal* brings us some of the most compelling art of its time, capturing the essence of the era of experimentation. ■

> The exhibition covers *art of the post-Independence period, its adoption of social themes* and the expansion of India's art world

—Priya Pathiyan

The exhibition is on till Jun. 11